

MS Word Essentials

Chapter 3 · Character Formatting



Course Roadmap — 20 Chapters

MS Word Essentials · Guided practice every chapter, full assignment every 4

01	Getting Started with MS Word	
02	Basic Text Entry & Editing	
03	Character Formatting	
04	Paragraph Formatting	
05	Practice Assignment 1	
06	Working with Lists	
07	Page Setup & Layout	
08	Headers, Footers & Page Numbers	
09	Working with Tables	
10	Practice Assignment 2	
11	Inserting Images & Shapes	
12	Styles & Themes	
13	Using Templates	
14	Spelling, Grammar & Proofing	
15	Practice Assignment 3	
16	Track Changes & Reviewing	
17	Mail Merge Basics	
18	Long Documents: TOC & Footnotes	
19	Sharing, Exporting & Printing	
20	Final Project: Build Your CV	

▲ TODAY

[Recap](#) · [Chapter 2](#)

Recap: Chapter 2

1

Keyboard Beats Mouse

Arrow keys, Home/End, and Ctrl+Arrow move you faster than clicking.

2

Selection Has Levels

Double-click, triple-click, and Ctrl+A each select a different amount.

3

Cut, Copy, Paste = X, C, V

Three shortcuts you'll use in almost every document.

4

Undo Fixes Almost Anything

Ctrl+Z is always your safety net.

Preview

Today's Objectives

1

Apply Bold, Italic & Underline

Add basic emphasis to text so key words and phrases stand out to your reader.

2

Change Font & Font Size

Choose the right typeface and size for headings, body text, and everything in between.

3

Use Font Color & Highlighting

Draw attention to specific text with color, without overdoing it on a professional document.

4

Apply Text Effects & Fix Case

Use strikethrough, superscript, and case tools to format text exactly the way you need it.

Theory · Basic Emphasis

Bold, Italic & Underline

1

Ctrl+B for Bold

Makes selected text thicker and darker — the most common way to emphasize a word or heading.

2

Ctrl+I for Italic

Slants text to the right, often used for book titles, foreign words, or subtle emphasis.

3

Ctrl+U for Underline

Draws a line beneath text — use sparingly, since underlines can look like clickable links.

4

Combine Them

You can apply bold, italic, and underline together on the same text for stronger emphasis.

Font & Font Size

1

The Font Dropdown

Found on the Home tab — changes the entire typeface of your selected text instantly.

2

Font Size Box

Right next to the font name — type a number or use the arrows to resize text.

3

Serif vs. Sans-Serif

Serif fonts, like Times New Roman, suit formal print.
Sans-serif fonts, like Calibri, suit screens and reports.

4

Grow & Shrink Font Shortcuts

Ctrl+] increases the size one point at a time. Ctrl+[decreases it. No mouse needed.

Font Color & Highlighting

1

Font Color Tool

Changes the color of the text itself — useful for headings or drawing subtle attention.

2

Text Highlight Color

Adds a background color behind text, like a real highlighter marker on paper.

3

Use Color with Purpose

Reserve color for what truly matters — too much color makes a document harder to read.

4

Theme Colors

The color palette matches your document's theme. This keeps your choices consistent and professional.

Text Effects & Case

1

Strikethrough

Draws a line through text — commonly used to show a deleted or completed item.

2

Superscript & Subscript

Raises or lowers text slightly, needed for footnotes, exponents, and chemical formulas.

3

Change Case

Instantly switches selected text between UPPERCASE, lowercase, and Capitalize Each Word.

4

Clear All Formatting

Ctrl+Spacebar strips bold, color, and every other style back to plain default text.

PRACTICE

Bold, Italic & Underline

1

Bold a Heading

Type the heading “Why Formatting Matters” and this sentence below it: “Good formatting makes a document easier to read and more professional.” Bold the heading with Ctrl+B.

2

Italicize a Phrase

Select the words “easier to read” in your sentence and apply italic with Ctrl+I.

3

Underline a Key Term

Underline the word “professional” with Ctrl+U.

4

Combine All Three

Select the word “formatting” in the heading and apply bold, italic, and underline together.

PRACTICE

Change Fonts & Sizes

1

Change the Font

Select your whole sentence and switch it to Georgia.

2

Resize a Heading

Make your heading larger — try 16pt or 18pt — using the font size box.

3

Try the Shortcuts

Select the word “formatting” in your heading and use Ctrl+] and Ctrl+[to grow and shrink it.

4

Compare Two Fonts

Type “This is Times New Roman.” in that font. Type it again below, in Calibri. Compare how each one reads.

Wrap-Up

Key Takeaways

1

Bold, Italic, Underline = B, I, U

Three simple shortcuts cover most of the emphasis you will ever need.

2

Font Choice Sets the Tone

Serif fonts feel formal and traditional. Sans-serif fonts feel modern and clean on screen.

3

Use Color Sparingly

Font color and highlighting work best when reserved for the few things that truly matter.

4

Ctrl+Spacebar Resets Everything

When formatting gets messy, clearing it and starting fresh is often the fastest fix.

Next up — Chapter 4: Paragraph Formatting